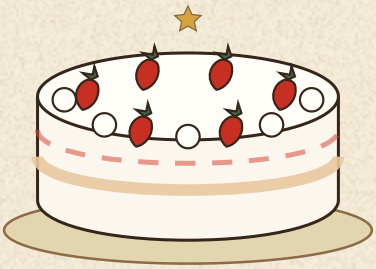
クリスマスケーキ

The Japanese Christmas cake

the all-white strawberry cake Japan eats at Christmas



One 18 cm (7 in) round tin **8** slices **1 h 30** + 1 h in the fridge

Ingredients

THE SPONGE

Eggs	3
Sugar	90 g
Flour	90 g
Butter	20 g
Milk	20 ml

THE SYRUP

Water	50 ml
Sugar	25 g

THE CREAM

Whipping cream, very cold	400 ml
Sugar	35 g

THE STRAWBERRIES

Strawberries	500 g

Steps

1. Heat the oven to 170 °C (340 °F). Butter an 18 cm round tin and line it with baking paper.
2. In a bowl set over a pan of hot (not boiling) water, whisk the eggs and sugar until lukewarm. Off the heat, whisk 5 to 8 more minutes: the mix turns pale and thick and falls in a ribbon.
3. Sift the flour over it in two goes. Fold gently with a spatula, from the bottom up, to keep the air in.
4. Melt the butter with the milk. Pour it over the spatula, then fold quickly and briefly.
5. Pour into the tin. Drop it from 10 cm onto the table to burst the big bubbles. Bake 30 to 35 minutes, until a skewer comes out clean. Turn out and let it cool.
6. Boil the syrup's water and sugar, then let it cool.
7. Whip the cream with the sugar until it holds its shape (keep the bowl on ice if it is warm).
8. Cut the sponge into two layers and brush them with syrup. On the first: cream, halved strawberries, more cream. Lay the second layer on top.
9. Cover the whole cake with cream and smooth it. Decorate with dollops of cream and whole strawberries. Chill 1 hour before serving.

> Did you know? In Japan, the Christmas cake (kurisumasu kēki) is nearly always this red and white strawberry cake, often ordered in advance from a pastry shop. And on the evening of the 24th, many families eat fried chicken: a habit born from a 1974 advert.